

Abductions

DATE: 7/27/96 6:15 PM

Re: Dr. Steve Greer on "Abductions

7=27-96

I hope you are enjoying the summer. My wife has been away in England these past 3 weeks with a girlfriend and I've been stuck with the pets, watering the plants and surviving 2 wacked out teenagers. My daughter will be 18 in the year 2000. I will truly celebrate the end of the century. Is there life after parenting? It's wonderful and terrible all at the same time. So what else is new?

What follows is an exchange of 2 months past plus the result of my editing efforts. The first section will probably need to be further edited. I would prefer cutting out "scare the hell out of every 2 year old" to something a bit more mild. Steve of course should have the final say. I think we (I guess that should read "I") could prepare a series of documents from that edited transcript of the Crestone talk that appears in the WG kit. That might form a series of position papers for general distribution or perhaps "talking points" for CSETI speakers training. I think we need to expand our outreach through forming a speaker's bureau. Of course quality control is always an issue with SG, appropriately so I might add. Who from the Crestone Ambassador's training impressed you as a possible spokesperson? Who would be totally inappropriate?

5-28-96

Dateline: Hollywood California

With the latest carnival of anti-Et xenophobia about to start with the opening of "The Arrival" this week and "Independence Day" on July 4, perhaps CSETI should publish some of Steven's cogent remarks of the subject of so called alien abductions. The Crestone workshop of Nov. 1993 had some very important material. I helped transcribe it for the WG kit and would volunteer for putting something together on "abductions" for online distribution. This time I promise no ghost writing.

If you all think it's a good idea I start work on it.

Peace.

Go for it.!

CSETI Position on Alleged Alien Abductions Dr. Steven Greer, Copyright 1996

In November of 1993 Dr. Steven Greer, CSETI International Director, gave a workshop in Crestone Colorado. The following are his edited remarks discussing the controversial issue of alleged alien abductions of humans.

Frightening Experience Doesn't Mean a Criminal Act has Occurred

Now there is plenty of evidence that some people have had frightening Close Encounters with Extraterrestrials and were frightened by the experience, but that is something quite different from proving that ET hostility. As a doctor I scare the hell out of every 2 year old that I have to look in the ear with an otoscope. Their being frightened does not mean that I'm going to eat them, although they may think I will. I believe that we should be as non-anthropomorphic as possible in considering this situation.

This of course doesn't mean that people haven't had experiences with the Extraterrestrials which frighten them, but their subjective reactions is very different from proving the ETs' activities are driven by malevolent intentions. People are constantly confusing their perceptions of an Et action, with the ET motivations driving those actions. This kind of confusion is the stuff that historic tragedies are made of. Wars are fought as a result of confusing perceptions of actions with motivations behind them. On a more personal level this is the stuff that marriages break up over. We must become aware of this kind of error when analyzing the phenomenon of ET civilizations visiting Earth.

Data Does Not Support the Allegations

People speak of Close Encounters of the Fourth Kind, where humans go aboard ET craft, and mislabel the phenomenon as the so called "alien abduction experience." These stories which have been the topic of all too many sensationalized books, movies and TV programs, are supposed to be evidence proving the malevolence of Extraterrestrial Intelligence. On the contrary, such reports say more about how we react to strange experiences and our willingness to assume malevolence than they provide useful information about the Extraterrestrial-human relationship. "Alien abduction" researchers tend to view that relationship totally within the confines of what they assume in a proven criminal act. Their data base is so poor that a careful analysis indicates that these reports and their conclusions are simply not credible. As the computer expression bluntly states, "garbage in, garbage out!" We in CSETI, on the other hand, have collected testimony demonstrating that there is a

tremendous amount of bias in the collection of these types of reported experiences. This bias unfortunately includes the from the prevailing so called experts of the "alien abduction experience". This is very worrisome. It is unethical, but it is what CSETI has been observing in the so called "alien abduction experience field."

Fear Sells!

n contrast to the "alien abduction experience" as it is promoted by the UFO ghetto and tabloid journalists, the cases with the most credibility are almost completely lacking in these types of experience. These less negative accounts of human-ET interactions have greater evidential strength by virtue of certain important characteristics. They involve multiple witnesses to the events described and the accounts are recalled spontaneously without the bias introduced by the hypnotic regression technique so much favored by the alien abductionists. Unfortunately these more positive accounts of human encounters with Extraterrestrials, some of which may involve medical cures of beneficial physiologic effects, are not being conveyed to the public. This situation exists partially because the more sensationalized and titillating stories feed the public's appetite for horror stories. We should remember only a relatively small number of viewers saw the movie "Gandhi", far fewer than the millions who pay to regularly see Freddie Krugger's continuing terror campaign in "Nightmare on Elm Street."

I've heard people express the opinion that the commercial factor is not as important in the UFO community. I have to strongly disagree with that notion. Some alien abduction researchers are getting six figure advances in cash for their books. If you don't think that this financial factor is driving much of what you are seeing and hearing in this field, then I suggest you are very naive! It serves no useful purpose to name additional names here. I prefer not to speak about anyone individually, but I am taking note of the collective irresponsibility of those investigators who are promoting information and analysis that is very false. CSETI researchers and their supporters need to have an independent analysis that is both objective and visionary, so that we are not swept up in the kind of hysteria that passes as science in the UFO subculture.

As I indicated before, in our culture fear sells. When Jesse Helms was running again an African American candidate for senator, you better believe the fear factor was brought out. In any political campaign the bottom line is that fear sells. Unfortunately most people respond more to fear, than they do to peace and love. Fear sells books and scripts for movies. It sells out workshops at UFO meetings. In carrying out our educational campaign, we must do so with our eyes open. We must acknowledge that much of what is being promoted within our culture about the presence of Extraterrestrial Intelligence, has corrupted people to the point where open relations with the ET visitors will be more difficult to achieve. At some point we must ask whose interests are served by this corruption and misinformation. I suspect that question will lead us to identifying more powerful forces than just some irresponsible section of the mass media. Perhaps we can discuss this point at a latter time.

CSETI's Assumption of Non-Hostility

Whether you are of the view that some ETs are positive or negative, the path of wisdom is to assume non-hostility until you can evaluate

the situation thoroughly. Reaching conclusions about the Extraterrestrials prematurely is fraught with danger. We must remember that we are dealing with races of intelligent beings who have evolved on different star systems. They undoubtedly have different customs, languages and morays compared to us, and very likely compared to each other. To avoid unnecessary conflict when addressing a process this important, we are required to assume the visitors are non-hostile, and we should continue doing so until proven otherwise beyond a shadow of a doubt. Only by taking this course can we avoid conflicts with the Extraterrestrials in situations where conflict need not take place. Our attempts at establishing open bilateral communication we believe is a necessary precondition for a more open, peaceful and mutually beneficial relationship. This is after all what the CSETI project is about.

Practical Lessons for Human Initiated Contact with Extraterrestrials

All this discussion of the fear factor relates in a practical sense to preparation for field work. Our success in meeting with the Extraterrestrials to a large extent will depend on our ability to overcome fear. Only then will we be open to identifying opportunities that can promote a positive and cooperative relationship with the Extraterrestrials. Can I tell you that if we go out into the field and a craft lands that there will be no possibility of a bad outcome? The answer to that question is an emphatic no! I can't promise you that, I don't think anyone can. We can take specific measures to minimize the risks of a bad outcome. As we have shown from the previous discussion, most harmful experiences have occurred when someone unwisely has gone up to these craft where they should not have gone. Our contact protocols have specific safety features built into them to minimize risk.

Just Telling Scary Stories in the Dark is Misguided

The Center for the Study of Extraterrestrial Intelligence is attempting to establish a citizens' diplomatic initiative with any and all Extraterrestrials who are visiting Earth at this time. We take this mission very seriously and we are inviting our fellow human beings to join us to start considering ways that we can positively interact with advanced ET civilizations. For those who are interested in the UFO phenomenon, we ask that they consider the consequences of starting our relationship with the ET visitors assuming that we are the victims of their alleged transgressions. Telling each other scary stories in the dark, selling sensationalized books that are distortions of the facts, assuming evil intentions, when there is very little credible evidence proving the ETs are harming us, these misguided activities can only lead to unnecessary conflict. They lead us away from the possibility of building a mutually beneficial open and direct relationship between our civilization and theirs. This issue is so important that it demands we go forward in a sober and responsible manner. The truth is, we know very little about the Extraterrestrials. They have evolved on different star systems from ours. They are likely to be an incredibly diverse group of cultures with different customs, ethical and religious systems. For us to assume that they are victimizing us, when we know so little about them, is not only ethnocentric in extreme but it likely rules out any possible benefit we might derive from knowing them. We will already address them in a conflict mode.

The Terms We Use Encapsulate our Consciousness

We should remember that all language reflects consciousness. The words we use encapsulate consciousness and the they are powerful because they shape how we will think and act. If the only words we use to describe the human-Extraterrestrial relationship are negative, fear based, and xenophobic, words like "abductions" and "mutilations", then we will not even be able to perceive of, let alone take advantage of whatever opportunities that might present themselves to us for establishing a mutually beneficial, open and direct relationship with the Extraterrestrials. So we have to be very careful as to what words we use to describe this phenomenon. This is especially so when we speak to the public. Once the awareness of ET civilizations visiting Earth becomes more a part of the mass consciousness, as the message breaks out of the UFO ghetto and we start breaking into the mainstream culture, the need to handle this subject in a responsible way will increase exponentially. It may not be long before this theme will be leaving the inside pages of the National Inquirer to arrive on the front pages of The New York Times. We must be very careful in selecting the words we use, not only in terms of maintaining our credibility but also in terms of social responsibility. It is not only important that we speak the truth that we can verify, but also that we do so in a way that does not cause unnecessary and unwarranted panic and alarm. In my opinion those dealing with this subject have not shown enough social consciousness and enough social responsibility. This is particularly true in the so called alien abduction and animal mutilation fields.